# County Council Meeting
## Beaufort County, SC

Bluffton Branch Library
120 Palmetto Way
Bluffton, SC 29910

**Monday, April 27, 2026**
**6:00 PM**

**MINUTES**

***Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting*** **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/384043**

**1. Call to Order**

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:08 PM

**Present**
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson,
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

**Absent**
Council Member Lawrence McElynn

**2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation**

Vice-Chair Tabernik led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

**3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA**

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

**4. Approval of Agenda**

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the agenda.

**Motion to Amend:** It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to amend the agenda to remove item #9 Discussion of a private security firm at specific early voting locations.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 10:0.

**Main Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the agenda as amended.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The main motion passed 10:0.

**5. Approval of Minutes**

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the minutes from County Council Budget Workshop April 9, 2026, Caucus and County Council April 13, 2026.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

**6. Administrators Report**

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
**https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/384043**

**8. Presentations**

a. FY2027 Budget Proposal from elected and appointed officials.

Maria Walls, Treasurer, presented the FY 2027 budget. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full presentation. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/384043**

**9. Approval of Consent Agenda**

**Motion:** It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve the consent agenda.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

**CONSENT AGENDA**

a. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. Approval of a contract for the Public Works Metal Roof Repairs via OMNIA Purchasing Cooperative ($229,521.33)

2. A change order to Davis & Floyd for the design of Briar's Creek Road ($92,950.00)

3. A Change Order to O'quinn Marine for Melrose Dock Repairs ($57,888.00)

**END OF CONSENT AGENDA**

**10. Agenda Items**

a. A Contract to Nix Construction for the construction of the Buckwalter Recreation Athletic Complex Expansion (BRACE) Project ($8,316,000.00)

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve a contract to Nix Construction for the construction of the Buckwalter Recreation Athletic Complex Expansion (BRACE) Project ($8,316,000.00).

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to take agenda items a and b together.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

**Voting Nay:** Council Member Dawson. The motion passed 9:1.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to fully fund the project at $14,636,380.00.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

**Voting Nay:** Council Member Dawson and Council Member Glover. The motion passed 8:2

b. A Contract to MUSCO Sports Lighting, LLC for the Buckwalter Recreation Athletic Complex Expansion (BRACE) Field Lighting ($593,890.00)

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

c. Reappointment of Daniel Anderson to the Construction Adjustments and Appeals Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the reappointment of Daniel Anderson to the Construction Adjustments and Appeals Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. Reappointment of Janet Porter to the Library Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the reappointment of Janet Porter to the Library Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council

Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

e. Reappointment of Robert Bible to the Board of Assessment Appeals for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the reappointment of Robert Bible to the Board of Assessment Appeals for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

f. Reappointment of Jessica Reitz to the Keep Beautiful Beaufort Board for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointment of Jessica Reitz to the Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Board for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

g. Reappointment of Bruce Kline to the Construction Adjustments and Appeals Board for a fourth term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the reappointment of Bruce Kline to the Construction Adjustments and Appeals Board for a fourth term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

h. Appointment of Sara Miller, District 4, to the Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the appointment of Sara Miller, District 4, to the Keep Beaufort County Beautiful Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

i. Appointment of Hattie Brown, District 1, to the Library Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the appointment of Hattie Brown, District 1, to the Library Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

j. Reappointment of Thomas Peth to the Daufuskie Island Fire District Board for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the reappointment of Thomas Peth to the Daufuskie Island Fire District Board for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

k. Reappointment of Nancy Ludtke to the Daufuskie Island Fire District Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the reappointment of Nancy Ludtke to the Daufuskie Island Fire District Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

l. Reappointment of Galen Sturup-Comeau to the Disabilities and Special Needs Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030, pending approval by the Governor's Office.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the reappointment of Galen Sturup-Comeau to the Disabilities and Special Needs Board for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030, pending approval by the Governor's Office.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

m. Reappointment of Barbara Childs to the Lowcountry Regional Transportation Authority (Palmetto Breeze) for a fifth term of three years, with an expiration date of April 2029.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointment of Barbara Childs to the Lowcountry Regional Transportation Authority (Palmetto Breeze) for a fifth term of three years, with an expiration date of April 2029.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

n. Reappointment of Henry Criss to the Lowcountry Regional Transportation Authority (Palmetto Breeze) for a second term of three years, with an expiration date of April 2029.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointment of Henry Criss to the Lowcountry Regional Transportation Authority (Palmetto Breeze) for a second term of three years, with an expiration date of April 2029.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

o. Reappointment of Lynne Hoos to the Zoning Board of Appeals for a third term of three years, with an expiration date of April 2029.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointment of Lynne Hoos to the Zoning Board of Appeals for a third term of three years, with an expiration date of April 2029.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

p. Reappointment of Chet Houston to the Lady's Island/St. Helena Island Fire District Commission for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030, pending approval by the Governor's Office.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the reappointment of Chet Houston to the Lady's Island/St. Helena Island Fire District Commission for a third term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

q. Appointment of Charles Newton to the Planning Commission for a three-year term with an expiration date of April 2029.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the appointment of Charles Newton to the Planning Commission for a three-year term with an expiration date of April 2029.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

r. Reappointment of Bruce Yeager to the Parks and Recreation Board for a fifth term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the reappointment of Bruce Yeager to the Parks and Recreation Board for a fifth term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

s. Appointment of Rick Krob to the Bluffton Township Fire District Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the appointment of Rick Krob to the Bluffton Township Fire District Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

t. Appointment of Phillip Mansker to the Parks and Recreation Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the appointment of Phillip Mansker to the Parks and Recreation Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

u. Appointment of Celina Morello to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the appointment of Celina Morello to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

v. Appointment of Caroline Atkins to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the appointment of Caroline Atkins to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

w. Appointment of Elizabeth Epstein to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the appointment of Elizabeth Epstein to the Design Review Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover,

Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

x. Appointment of Adam Saslow, District 8, to the Stormwater Management Utility Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the appointment of Adam Saslow, District 8, to the Stormwater Management Utility Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

y. Appointment of Dee Simpson, District 4, to the Stormwater Management Utility Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the appointment of Dee Simpson, District 4, to the Stormwater Management Utility Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

z. Reappointment of Paul Manning to the Beaufort County Transportation Committee for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Reitz to approve the reappointment of Paul Manning to the Beaufort County Transportation Committee for a second term of four years, with an expiration date of April 2030.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

aa. Appointment of Nick Borreggine to the Accommodations State (2%) Tax Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of April 2030.

**Motion:** It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the appointment of Nick Borreggine to the Accommodations State (2%) Tax Board for a four-year term with an expiration date of Ao.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Council Member Howard, Council Member Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, Council Member Reitz

## 11. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2026/08: An ordinance to amend Ordinance 2023/26 to reallocate funds previously appropriated for Daufuskie Island Ferry embarkation points to Sun City Joint Fire/EMS Station (Station #39).

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 - 8:0

The vote at First Reading on March 23, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 13, 2026 - 10:0
*N/A*

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/08.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/09: An Ordinance to reallocate the funds from the 2025 Series GO Bond for Passive Parks projects.

The vote at Finance, Administration and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on March 23, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/09.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

**12. Ordinances for Second Reading**

a. 2026/10: An Ordinance to reallocate remaining American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds in the amount of $739,108.13 towards existing projects as obligated to the Department of Treasury. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/10.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/11: An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the necessary documents and provide funding for the purchase of real property located at 641 Sea Island Parkway. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 -

8:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/11.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. 2026/12: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute the necessary documents to convey five parcels of real property TMS Nos. R120 005 000 0105 0000, R120 005 000 0127 0000, R120 005 000 0132 0000, R120 005 000 132A 0000, R120 005 000 0133 0000, to the Beaufort Jasper Housing Trust for development of attainable housing in partnership with Beaufort Memorial Hospital and other matters related thereto. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on March 16, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/12.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. 2026/13: An Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Ordinance Chapter 38 Environment, Article VII Green Space Program, Section 38-196 Method of Program and Procedures of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on April 06, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Chair Howard to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/13.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council

Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

e. 2026/14: An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the civil penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain exceptions and limitations thereto. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on April 6, 2026 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/14.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comments.

Joe Maiorano made public comments.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

f. 2026/15: An Ordinance to add a new Ordinance Section 54-9 Hate Intimidation Crime establishing the offense of hate intimidation and establishing a penalty for violations in the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on April 6, 2026 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 8:2:1

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/15.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, and Council Member Passiment.

**Voting Nay:** Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 4:6

g. 2026/16: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute the necessary documents to convey a parcel of real property TMS No. R100 033 00A 021B 000 to the Habitat for Humanity of the Lowcountry for development of workforce/affordable housing and other matters related thereto. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on March 2, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Reitz to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/16.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

**13. Ordinances for First Reading**

a. 2026/17: An Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Budget Ordinance for Fiscal Year 2026 (ordinance no. 2025/29) to amend section iii, County Operations revenues, and section iv, County Operations Appropriation

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on April 20, 2026 - 9:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/17.

**Motion to Amend:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to amend the Ordinance to appropriate $5,207,633.00 to go towards the Buckwalter Complex Project and that would move the total to $18,272,636.00.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

**Voting Nay:** Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Glover. The motion to amend passed 8:2.

**Main Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/17 as amended.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

**Voting Nay:** Council Member Dawson and Council Member Glover. The main motion passed 8:2.

b. 2026/18: An Ordinance Authorizing the Purchase of Real Property from the Town of Hilton Head Island for the St. James Baptist Church Relocation Project.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

c. 2026/19: An Ordinance Authorizing the Conveyance of Real Property to St. James Baptist Church Following Completion of the Relocation Project.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/18.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to Take Ordinance 2026/18 and Ordinance 2026/19 as one motion.

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/18 and 2026/19.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. 2026/20: An Ordinance to appropriate fund balance from Funds 1401 & 1600 to fund the USCB Convocation Center Project.

   The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on April 20, 2026 - 4:5

e. 2026/21: An Ordinance to Amend Ordinance 2025/20 to re-allocate funds from the 2025 Series GO Bonds to fund the University of South Carolina-Beaufort's Convocation Center Project.

   The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on April 20, 2026 - 4:5

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/20 and Ordinance 2026/21.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment.

**Voting Nay:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 4:6.

f. 2026/22: An Ordinance to amend the current Disaster Recovery Ordinance.

   The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/22.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

g. 2026/23: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute all necessary documents to convey the County’s Right of Way Interest in a segment of Scheper Lane to SCDOT and to accept the SCDOT Right of Way Interest in a segment of Roosevelt Avenue into the County Road Inventory.

   The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Chair Howard to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/23.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

h. 2026/24: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute any and all necessary documents for the acceptance of a portion of Airport Circle (S-776) which is to be abandoned by SCDOT.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Chair Howard to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/24.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

i. 2026/25: An Ordinance authorizing the conveyance of an undeveloped portion of real property adjacent to Nanny Cove Road located in a section of Palmetto Beach in Bluffton Township, Beaufort County.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/25.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

## 14. Resolutions

a. 2026/15: A Resolution of the County Council of Beaufort County adopting a merit pay policy and associated appendix to the Beaufort County Personnel Handbook.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on April 20, 2026 - 8:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/15.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

*Vice-Chair Tabernik stepped out

b. 2026/16: A Resolution to Commission Solid Waste and Recycling Enforcement Officer.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/16.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

*Vice-Chair Tabernik stepped out

c. 2026/17: A Resolution endorsing the updated Beaufort County Disaster Recovery Plan.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/17.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. 2026/18: A Resolution to accept a South Carolina Aeronautics Commission (SCAC) Commercial Airport Entitlement grant in the amount of $1 Million for the Hilton Head Island Airport Terminal Improvement Project, Phase II - Contingent upon final grant offer.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee On April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/18.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

e. 2026/19: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to enter into an MOU with the Port Royal Sound Foundation.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0

**Motion:** It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/19.

**The Vote - Voting Yea:** Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

**15. Adjournment**

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____

Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:



Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: May 11, 2026